

— A SRISHTI STUDIOS —
PRESENTS

KAGE NO KOE

影の声

CHAPTER 3 THE HIDDEN TRUTH



The clues led Ren and Aiko to an abandoned temple said to be lost in the mountains — a place where the past refused to stay buried.

2

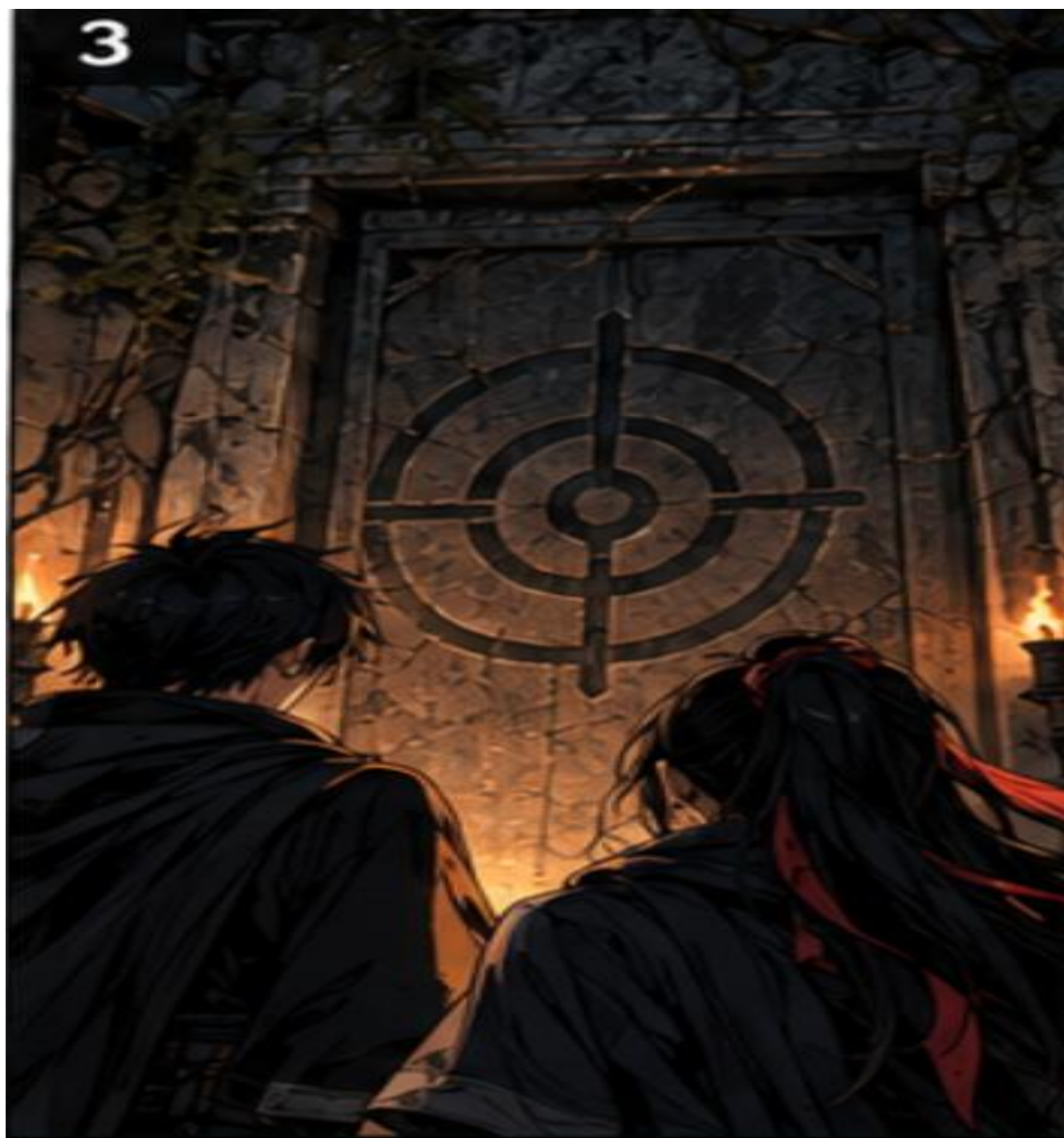


After a long and difficult climb, they finally reached the temple.

Ren: "This is it... The place from the records."

Aiko: "It feels different here..."

3



The same symbol — but larger.

Aiko: "So the stories were true."

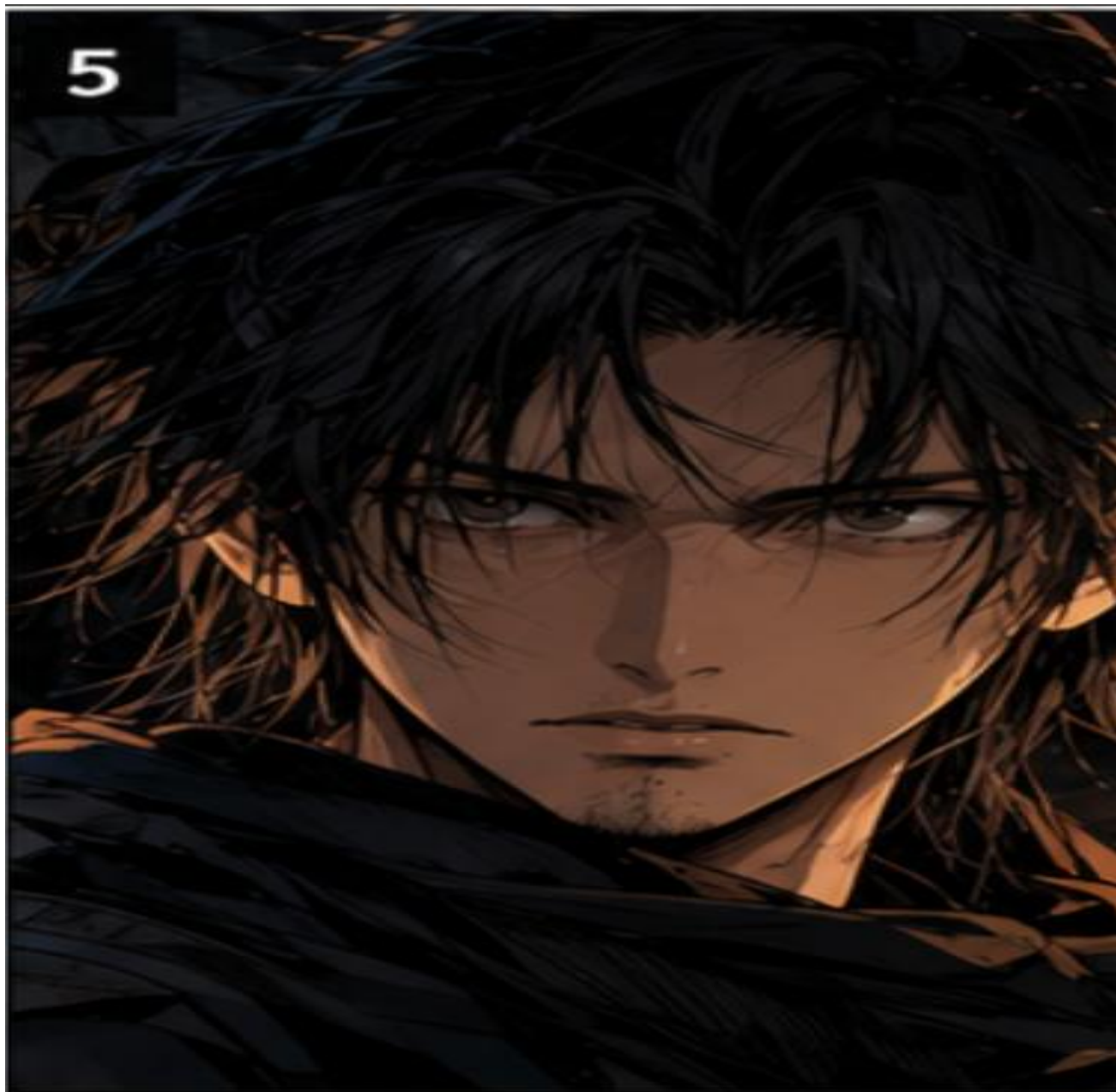
Ren: "This is more than a temple...
It's a message."

4



As Ren touched the symbol,
a faint voice echoed in his mind.

A voice: "To know the truth...
face what you fear."



Ren: "These voices...
They are not just memories.
They are warnings."

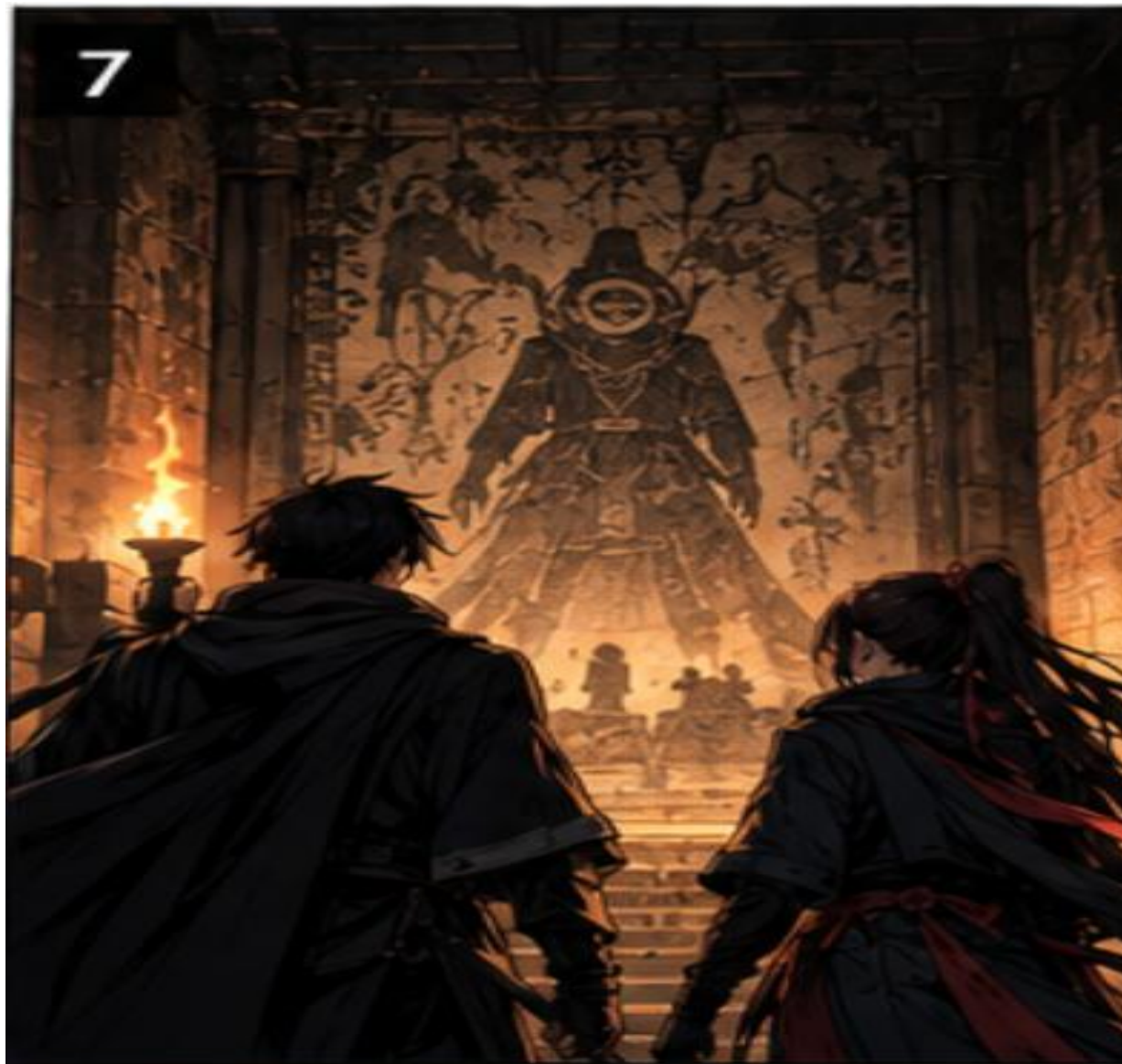
Aiko: "Then someone wanted
us to find this."

6



Aiko: "This wasn't built for worship. It was built to hide something."

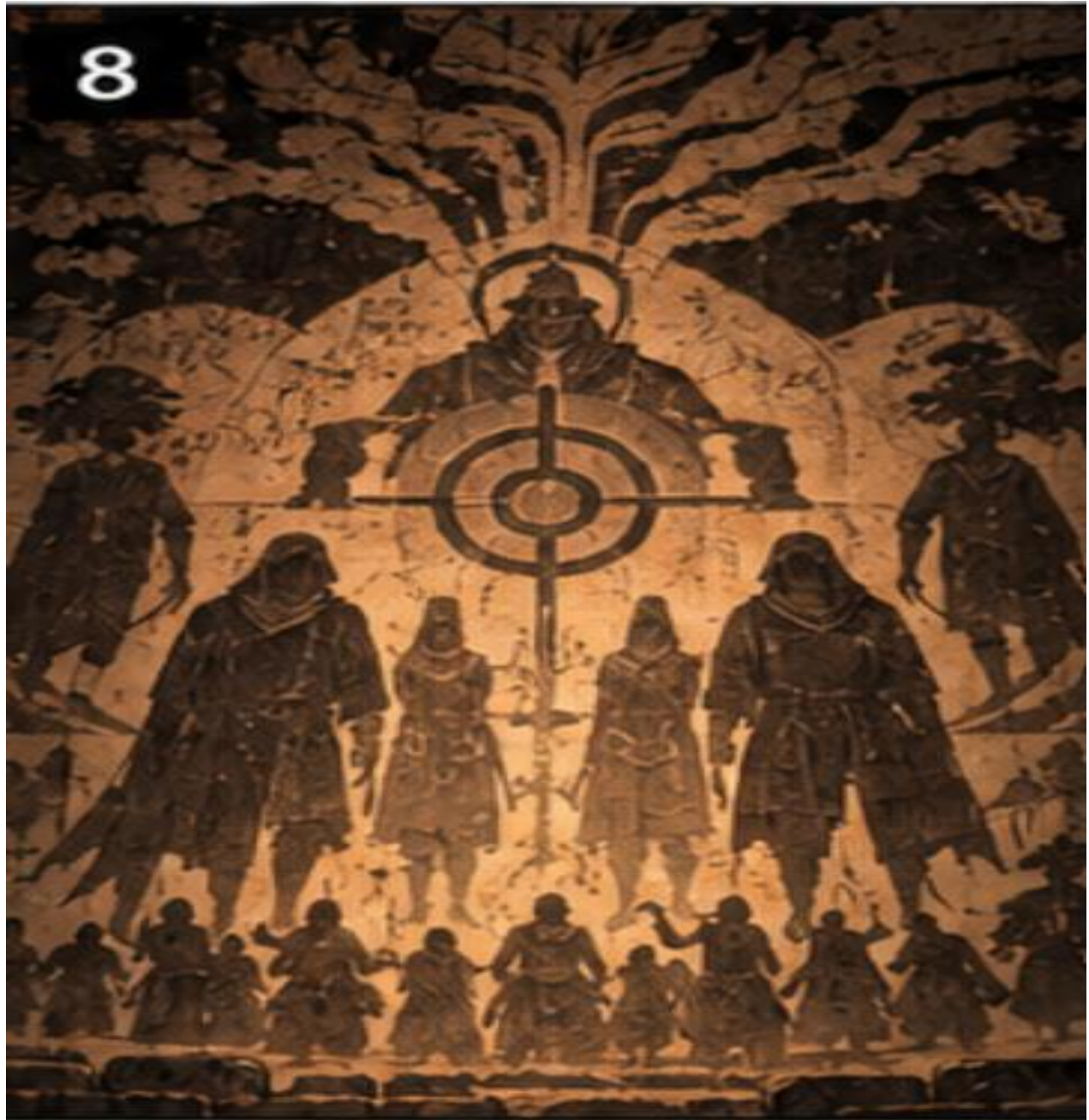
Ren: "And someone is still protecting that secret."



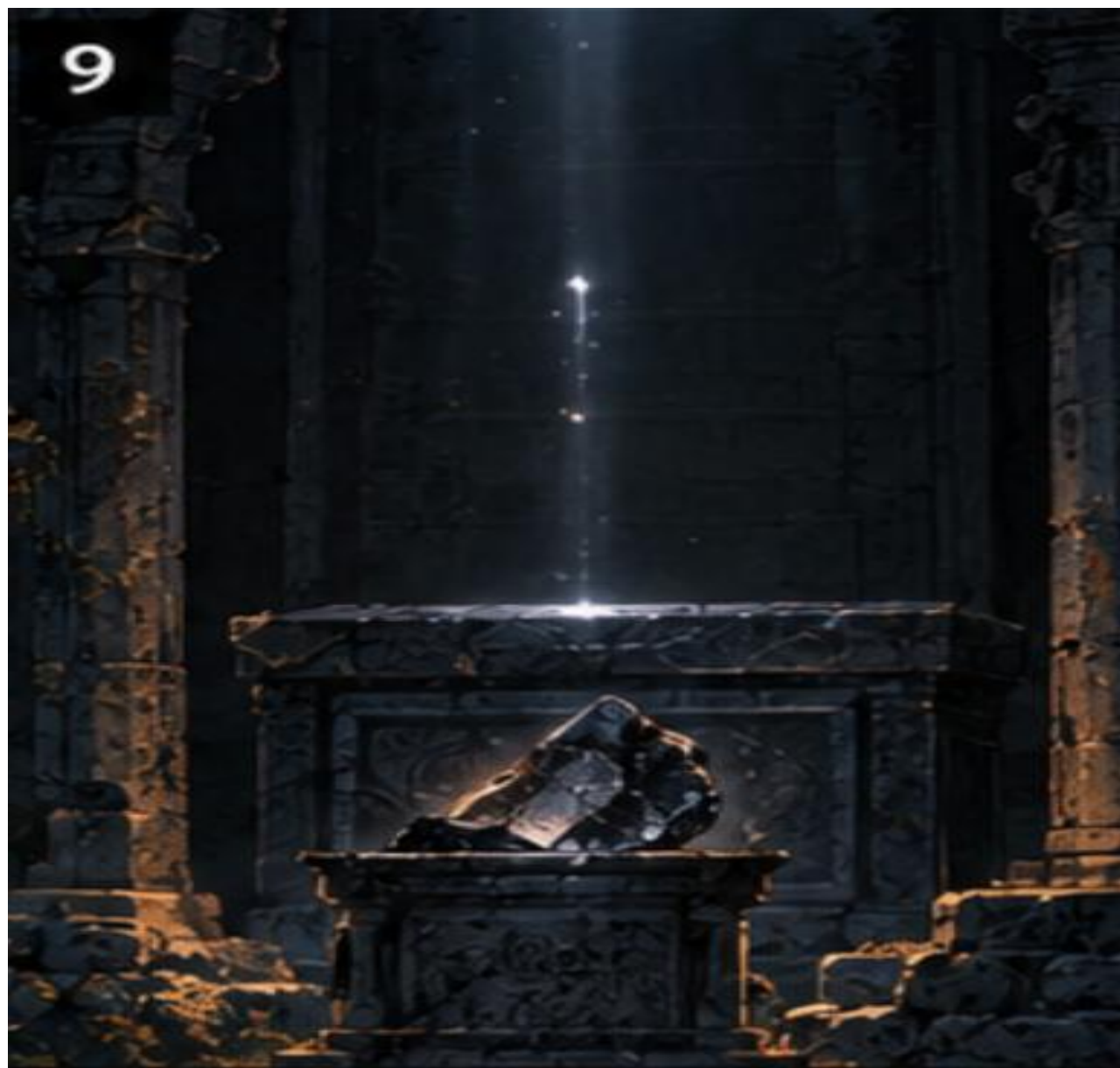
Inside, they found murals showing the same symbol — and people who looked like the Keepers.

Aiko: "They were watching over something... or keeping something away."

8



Ren: "This looks like a seal...
Not a story.
They hid the truth here
on purpose."



At the center of the chamber lay another fragment — similar to the one Ren had.

Aiko: "This must be the second piece."

Ren: "There's still more... We're not at the end yet."



When the two fragments were brought together, the symbol aligned — but instead of answers, a new vision appeared.

A voice: “The mountain is only the beginning.”

Before dawn, Ren and Aiko saw it — the peak of the seventh mountain.



So this is it...

Hidden beyond the ridges,
it stood above the clouds
— untouched by time.

12

The path to the summit
was unlike the others.

It feels different here.

The air...
It's too quiet.

Even the wind held its breath,
as if the mountain itself
was listening.



At the entrance, they found stone guardians — seven of them, facing inward.



This place was never meant to be found.

Each one carried the same symbol — the circle with a line.

Ren examined the carvings on the gate.

These are not just decorations.
They tell a story...
a warning.

The same symbol...
but here it is surrounded by
seven marks — like seven voices.

15

Aiko noticed something
on the side wall.

Look at this...

HOSHIMURA
TSUKINAMI
MIZUKAWA
KIRISAME
AKANOE
YAMATSUKI
KAGAMORI

Names. The same villages
we visited. But there's one more.

The seventh name... Kagamori.
The source.

16

Inside the temple, a massive mural revealed the truth.

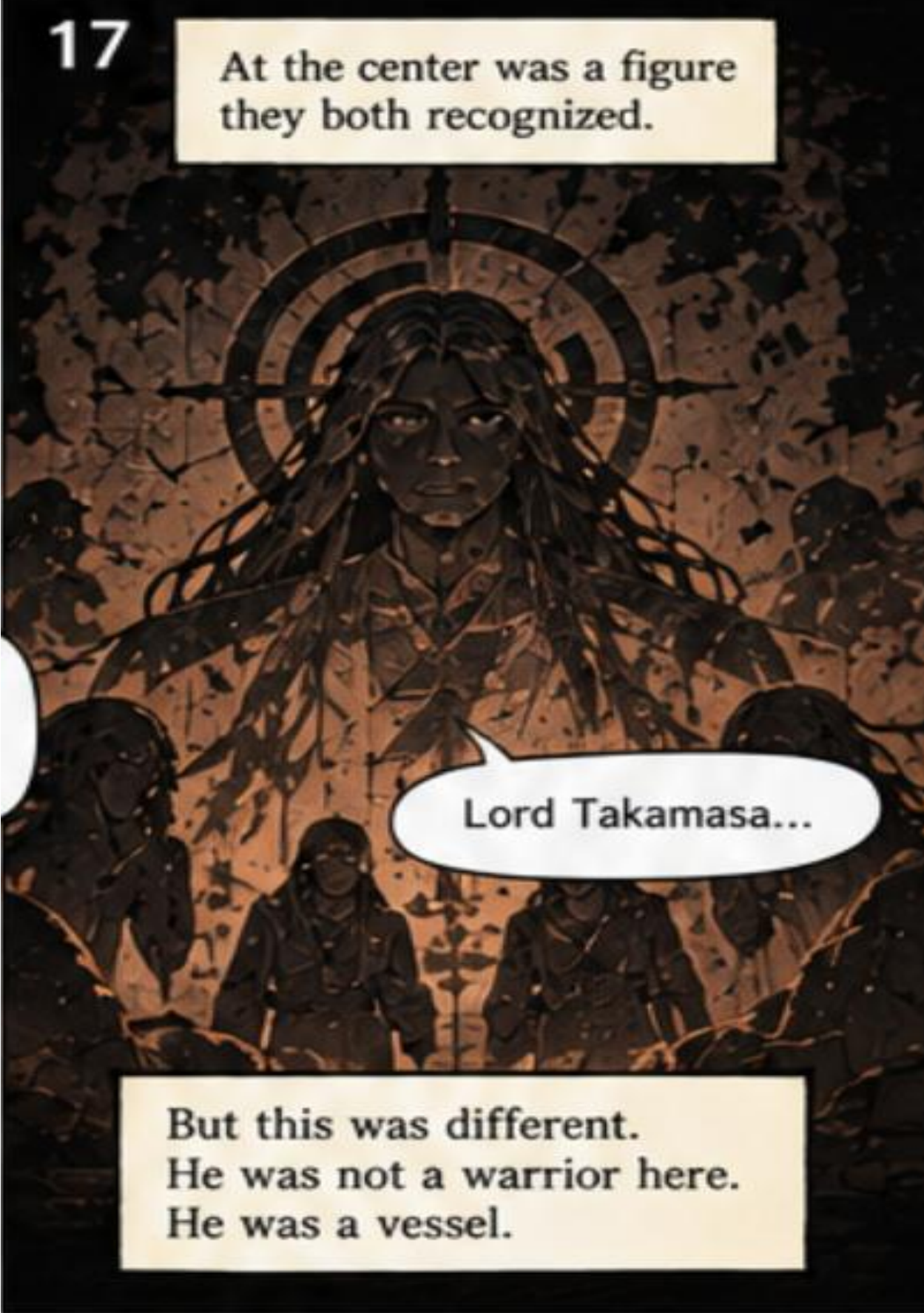


So it wasn't just a story...
All the voices were meant
to converge here.

Seven voices. Seven villages.
All leading to a single center.

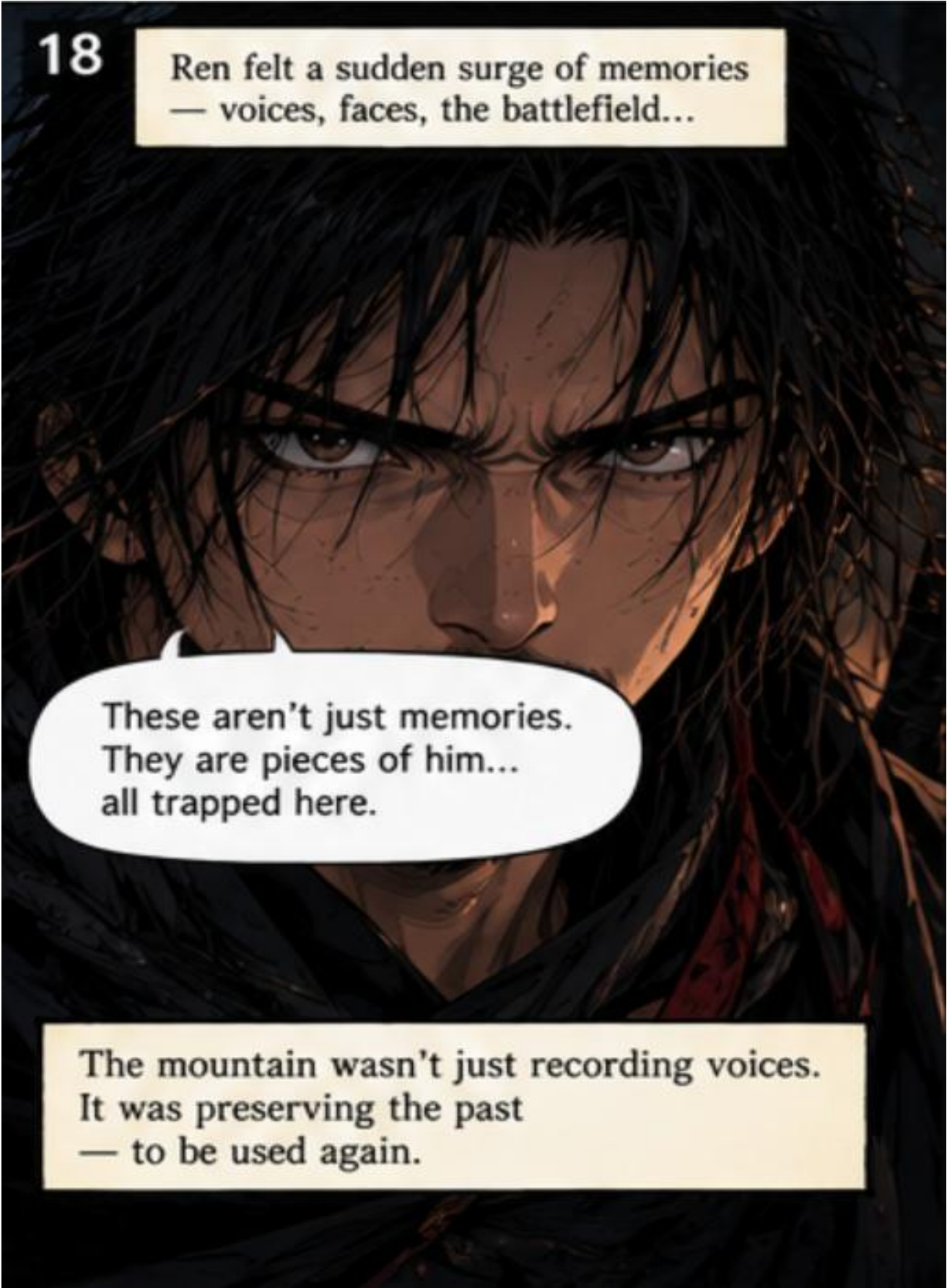
But why?
What is the purpose?

At the center was a figure they both recognized.



Lord Takamasa...

But this was different.
He was not a warrior here.
He was a vessel.



18

Ren felt a sudden surge of memories
— voices, faces, the battlefield...

These aren't just memories.
They are pieces of him...
all trapped here.

The mountain wasn't just recording voices.
It was preserving the past
— to be used again.

Aiko looked at the mural again.

This place doesn't just hold voices, Ren...
It holds regrets.

And someone wants to use them.

If the past can speak,
then it can also be twisted.

20

At the far end of the chamber,
they found something — the final fragment.

You should not
have come this far...

But as they moved closer,
a low voice echoed through the hall...



Ren and Aiko froze as the voice echoed through the chamber.

Show yourself.

You already know me.

The final fragment began to vibrate, as if responding to the voice.



The walls of the chamber began to change.

These are from the Battle of Kirisame...

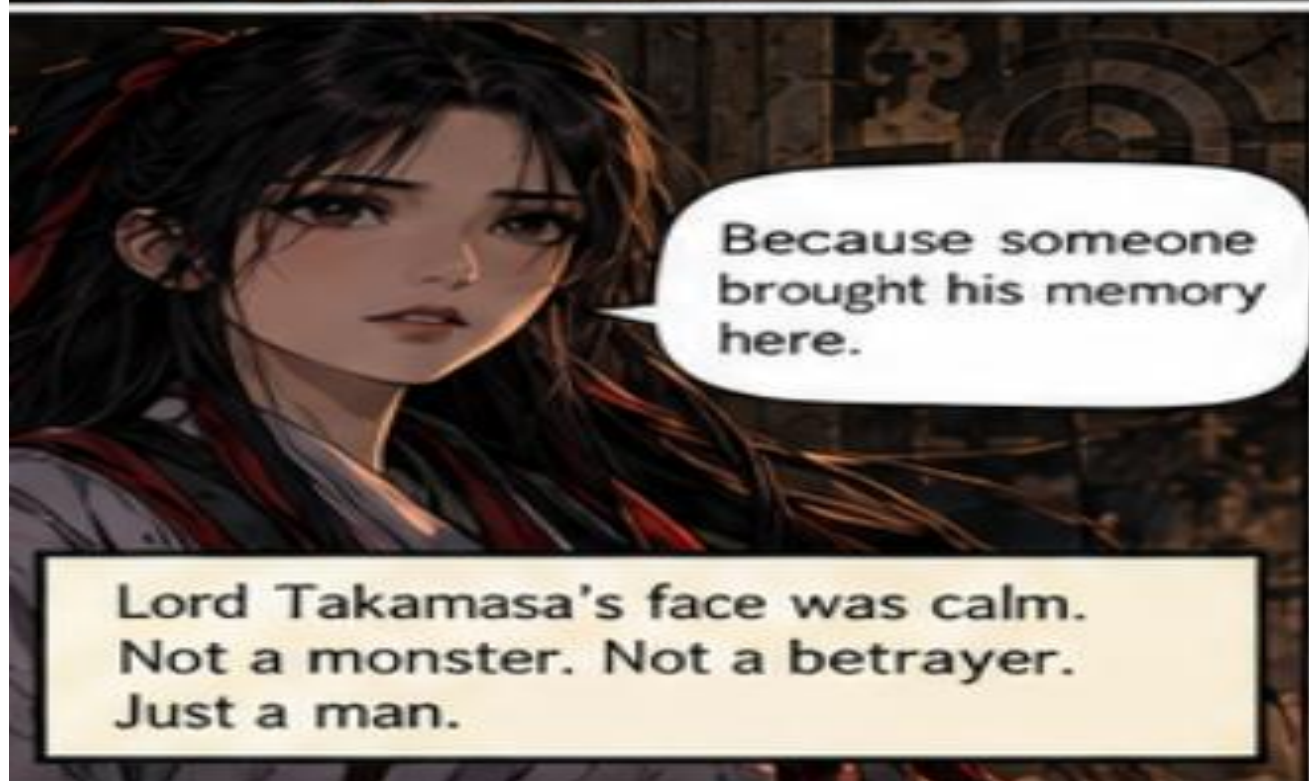
The mountain has been collecting memories... for centuries.

It was not just a temple — it was an archive of the dead.

Among the images, Renjiro saw a familiar face.



Why is he here?



Because someone brought his memory here.

Lord Takamasa's face was calm.
Not a monster. Not a betrayer.
Just a man.

A dark pool began to form beneath the altar.

Do not let the fragments touch the pool.

You knew this would happen.

I only hoped you would be wiser than those before you.

The Nameless Monk had returned.

25

The fragments began to pull towards each other, resisting Renjiro's hands.



No... stay back!



I won't let this happen!

But the pull was stronger than either of them.

The pool's surface showed
not water, but memories.



Renjiro...
listen before
you answer.



Lord Takamasa...?

It was a memory —
but it felt real.

Aiko understood what was happening.

The voices here are not the dead themselves.

The mountain preserves their memories...
It can make the dead speak...
but it cannot make them alive.

...So what we hear is real... but incomplete.

Memories can tell the truth...
and still not be the whole truth.

The Nameless Monk revealed the truth.

The seven mountains were built by an ancient order — the Keepers.

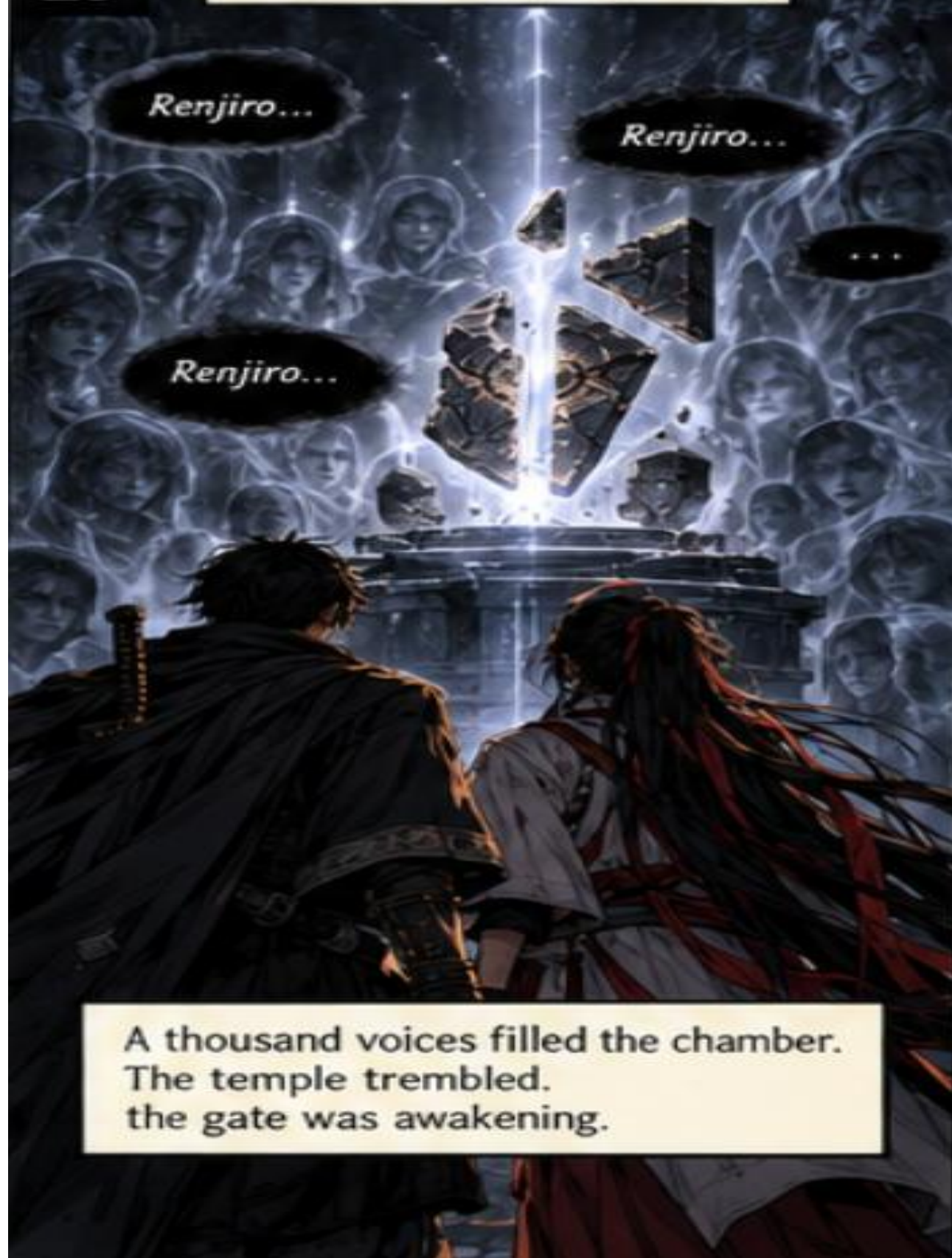
They collected the memories of the fallen, so truth would never be lost to time.

But some memories are too powerful.

So they sealed a source beneath this seventh mountain.

Kagegami was only a fragment of the source.

What you hold now...
can either preserve the truth...
or unleash it be thrve.

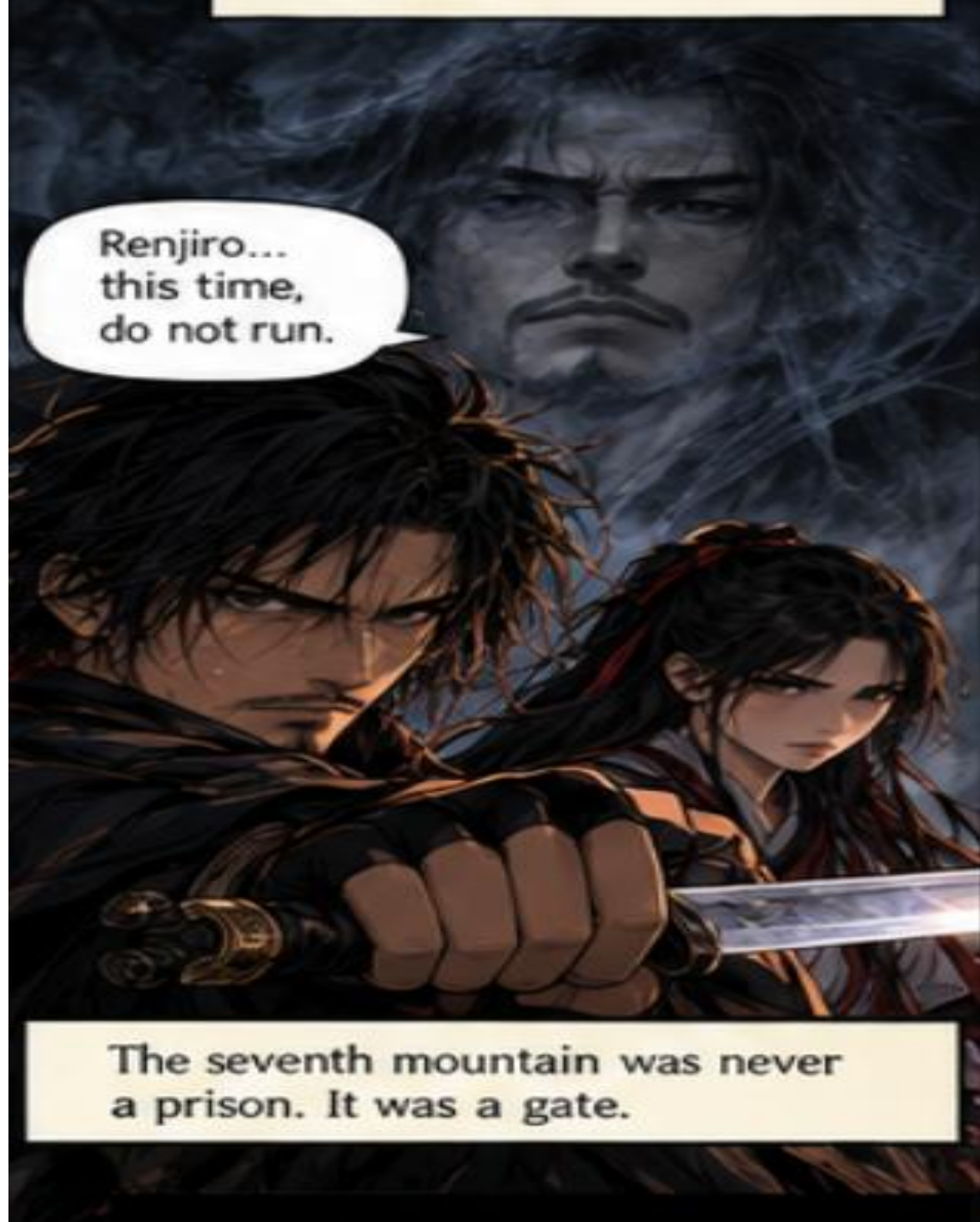


A thousand voices filled the chamber.
The temple trembled.
the gate was awakening.

From the depths of the darkness,
a familiar voice spoke — clearer
than before.

Renjiro...
this time,
do not run.

The seventh mountain was never
a prison. It was a gate.



As the fragments aligned, a hidden space opened — a place between memory and reality.



So this is it...
the source.

It feels...
like we are inside
a memory.

The seventh mountain did not
hold a treasure, but a world —
built from voices.

Lord Takamasa appeared
within the sea of voices.

Renjiro...

You have come far.

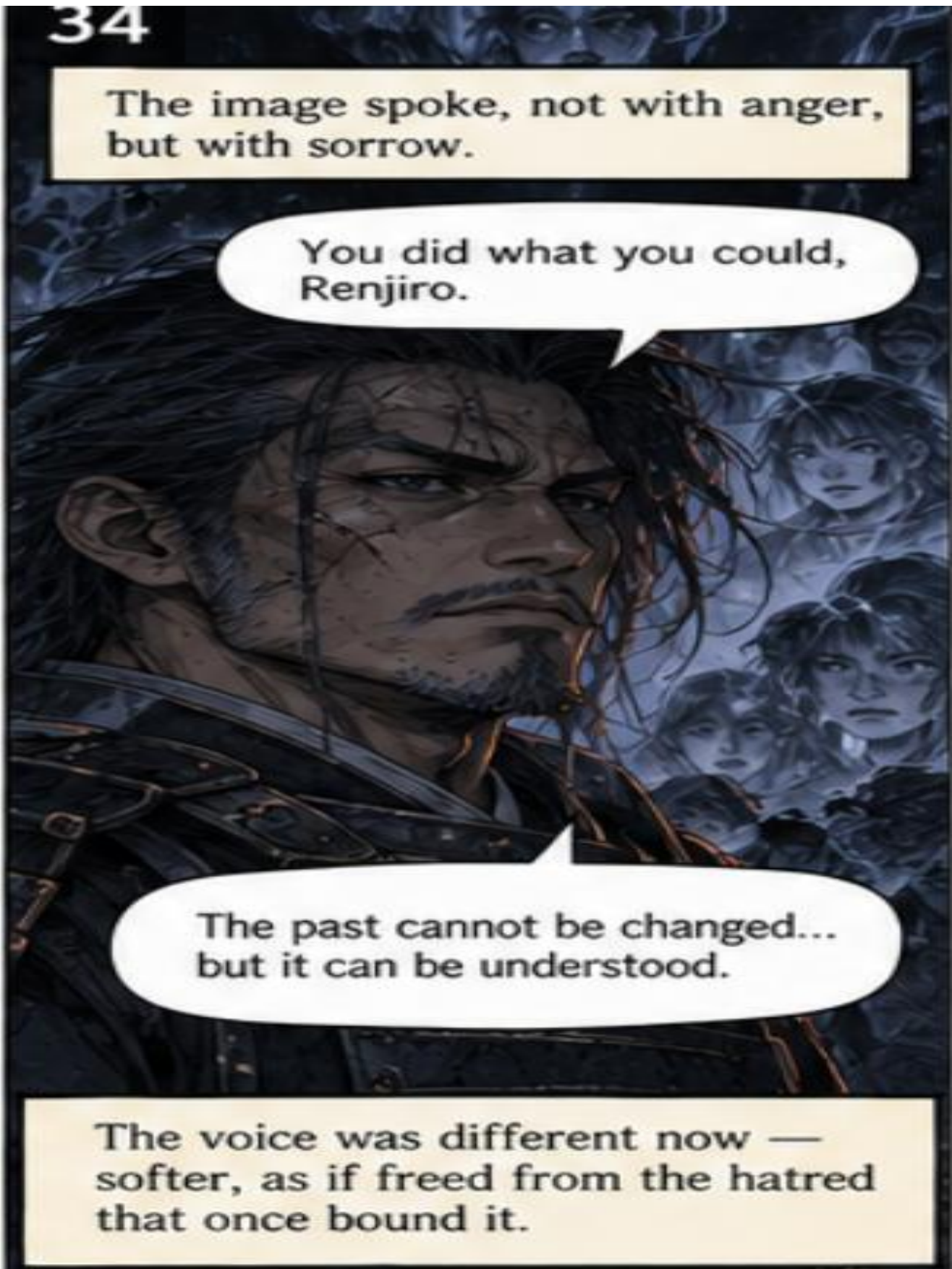
He was not truly there...
but his presence felt real enough
to shake Renjiro's heart.

Renjiro faced the image
of the man he once served.



Lord Takamasa...
Was it all my fault?
Did I fail you?

The voices around him whispered
guilt, blame, and regrets —
every memory he had buried.



The image spoke, not with anger,
but with sorrow.

You did what you could,
Renjiro.

The past cannot be changed...
but it can be understood.

The voice was different now —
softer, as if freed from the hatred
that once bound it.

Aiko's own memories appeared — her village, her family, now lost to time.

A close-up illustration of a young woman with long, dark hair and a determined expression. Her hair is slightly messy, and she has a small tear on her cheek. The background is dark and filled with faint, ethereal images of people's faces, representing memories. A speech bubble is positioned above her head.

These voices are not just of warriors... they are of everyone who was forgotten.

We cannot let them be used again.

Her resolve grew stronger. This was no longer just Renjiro's past — it was their shared purpose.

But as the truth surfaced,
a new presence emerged —
the Guardian of the Source.



You seek to free
the voices?

Then you must face
what you truly fear.

It was not a memory...
It was a protector —
created to keep the source sealed.

— Renjiro and Aiko stood together, ready to face it.

No matter what it is...
We face it together.

We didn't come this far
to turn back now!

They were no longer just seeking answers — they were fighting for a future where no one would be silenced.

As the battle began, the chamber itself started to break apart.



The source was awakening.
The voices, the memories, the past
and present — all began to merge.

And within that light...
something new was born.

The fragments, now united,
shone with a new light.



The symbol was complete —
but it no longer represented
imprisonment.

It became a gateway.

A gateway to hear the truth...
not to be trapped by it.

As the chamber faded, a path appeared — leading beyond the seventh mountain.

This is not the end.

It's a new beginning.

There are still voices to be heard.
Still mountains to be explored.
But now...
we walk forward with the truth.

TO BE CONTINUED...

CHAPTER 3, PART IV